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Windows XP Media Center PCs are already gracing the shelves of PC stores all over India. It is finally being realised that the Windows XP Media Center PC, which comprises the OS along with the compatible hardware, is the ultimate convergence of personal computing and entertainment. The ability to capture live TV or to be able to view TV at your own pace, so to speak, makes it an attractive replacement for the TV as well as the regular PC.

Windows XP Media Center PCs use a new format known as DVR-MS (which derives its name from Digital Video Recorder). Video of this type is encoded in the MPEG-2 format. DVR-MS files can also be copy-protected by the author, thus allowing them to be run only on the Media Center PC that was used to record the content.

The DVR-MS file format captures live telecasts at excellent quality levels, but there is a drawback. The size of the captured file is huge. A two-hour capture at the best quality settings would take up a whopping 5.5 GB of hard disk space! And DVR-MS files cannot be easily edited. This is why you might want to convert files from this format into a format such as WMV, which not only occupies only a fraction of the space for almost the same quality, but can also be edited.

Thankfully, there is software known as Digital Media Converter from www.deskshare.com which does this job for you. Not only is it capable of converting unprotected DVR-MS files to the WMV format, it can also convert them to the VCD, DVD, AVI (DivX, MS MPEG4, uncompressed, etc), MPEG-1, MPEG-2 (PAL, NTSC), MOV,

WMA, and WAV formats, and also batch-convert them.

Before you proceed, you must make sure your system meets the minimum system requirements. For a Windows XP Media Center PC, you need to download and install an MPEG-2 encoder such as the freeware from www.deskshare.com/download/mpeg2decoder.exe. For Windows XP Home and Professional, you require Service Pack 2, Windows Media Player 9, DirectX 9c and the above MPEG-2 decoder. Let's get started!

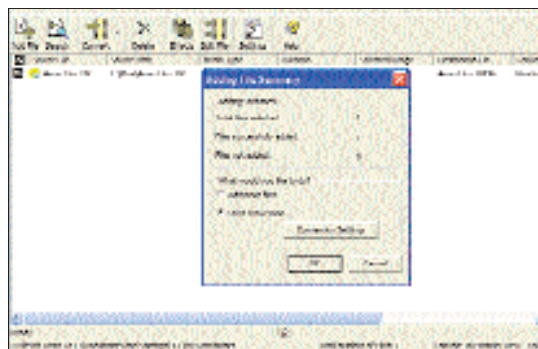
1. Launch the program. Go to **File > Add Files**, or click on the toolbar button labelled Add Files.

2. Browse to the folder where the files you want to convert are stored. Select one or more files you'd like to convert.

3. Select the "Convert to" format and click Open.

At this point, the Digital Media Converter will start adding the files one by one, and will display an error message if it is not able to add any of the files, and will also display the reason for it not being able to add the file. This converter is intelligent: instead of just displaying the error, it will also instruct you about what you may need to install in order to be able to convert the file.

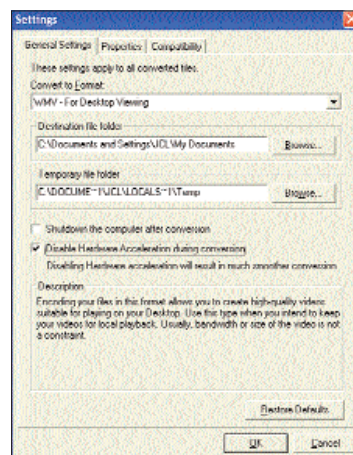
4. If you need to remove a file from the list, just select that file and click Delete in the Edit menu.



Add video files to Digital Media Converter

5. You may wish to change the conversion settings before you convert the files to your preferred format. To choose the format of the converted file, go to **Tools > Settings**. Select a format from the "Convert To" box. Click on the Properties tab to change the settings of the selected "Convert To" format. Click OK.

6. To configure an automatic shutdown after batch conversion, go to **Tools > Settings**, and check the "Shut down the computer after conversion" option. Click OK.



Disable Hardware Acceleration during conversion

7. You can disable hardware acceleration—this will result in smoother conversion, as fewer system resources are used. To disable hardware acceleration, click on **Tools > Settings**, check the box next to 'Disable Hardware Acceleration during conversion' and click on OK.



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